Theology and Counseling (COUN 5773)
Spring 2024

***Instructions for Field Work: Anthropological Observations* (10% each/x2)**

Field experience takes place through observations of the anthropologies embedded in one of two settings: 1) in a setting of Christian worship or another site of religious practice and 2) another event or setting which identifies an anthropology embedded in a common socio-cultural site or practice. These should range from between 750-1000 words.

The assignment addresses the following (in an approximately 80% observation/interpretation and 20% evaluative proportion):

- **What is the underlying (implicit) anthropology (understanding of the human) in this event?**
- **What is the human (according to the underlying assumptions)?**
- **What are expectations of the persons involved in this event and how do these expectations reflect the norms and underlying ideas about humanity which this community or social situation or event assumes?**
- **What does this event say about human purposes?**
- **What is going on that is habituating people, leading them into a way of life in this event?**
- **And, briefly, how do you evaluate what you have observed and interpreted here?**

The concept behind this assignment is that practices, habits, "liturgies" embed or teach or habituate understandings of the human into human beings, so that they teach us what the human is through our doing and being and becoming.

What does the event that you observed do to form humans?

Additional Prompts for Anthropological Observations

Who are the human beings in this event expected to be?

What are some of the roles that are being played? How might some of these roles relate to the whole lives of the persons involved?

What does this event assume about the purposes for the human beings involved in it? What does this event assume about the purposes of other persons?

What does the naming of people have to do with the understanding of the humans involved in this event?

What do the human power structures involved in this event look like? What is assumed? What might be contested?

What is the "unthought" going on about the humans involved in this event and humans in general? That is, what is so deeply assumed here that it might be an epiphany to recognize as a powerful assumption guiding this event?

How might this event relate to the larger life of this community in which the event is taking place?

What are the explicit beliefs that are espoused during this event? What are some beliefs that seem to be implicit in it and the community?

What seems to give meaning to this event? How does that meaning resonate with the participants, or not?

What are some of the ethical structures embedded in this event and, as you might infer from your observation, perhaps the wider community? How might the personal moralities of the persons involved in the event or in the community relate to these ethical structures?

Was there anything odd or surprising to you about the expectations of those involved in this event?

Did you find things to be moral or immoral, ethical or unethical?

Did you find things to be spiritually enriching or problematic or harmful or anything else along these lines?

What kind of humans is this event shaping those involved in it to be?

Grading Rubric:	A-range	B-range	C-range	D- and F-range
Grading Area				
Followed Directions (10%)	All directions are properly followed.	Almost all directions are properly followed.	Several lapses in following directions.	Numerous lapses in following directions.
Quality of Composition (10%)	No or almost no errors in writing. Quality of writing is altogether appropriate to a course at the entry-level of a master's program.	Several writing errors. Quality of writing is mostly appropriate to a course at the entry-level of a master's program.	A number of writing errors. Quality of writing includes lapses inappropriate to a course at the entry-level of a master's program.	Regular errors or problems in writing. Quality of writing has regular lapses inappropriate to a course at the entry-level of a master's program.
Appropriate Selection and Completion of Field Experience (20%)	Appropriate and substantial event is selected with proper completion of the observation.	An overall appropriate and substantial event is selected with proper completion of the observation, but there is a minor flaw in selection and completion.	There is a significant flaw in selecting and completing an observation on an appropriate and substantial event.	There is a major problem with selection and observation of the event so that there is altogether a lack of appropriate material for composing the report.
Narration of the Event (20%)	Well-developed and adequate narration of the event is provided to substantiate interpretation of religious and/or secular practices.	Mostly developed and mostly adequate narration of the event is provided to substantiate interpretation of religious and/or secular practices.	Somewhat developed and somewhat adequate narration of the event is provided to substantiate interpretation of religious and/or secular practices.	Narration of the event is inadequate to substantiate interpretation of religious and/or secular practices.
Interpretation of Underlying Anthropologies (40%)	Insightful and substantiated inferences concerning underlying anthropologies are drawn, with fitting modal strength applied to claims.	Substantiated inferences concerning underlying anthropologies are drawn, with fitting modal strength applied to claims.	Some substantiated inferences concerning underlying anthropologies are drawn, with some issues regarding modal strength applied to claims.	Inferences concerning underlying anthropologies are unsubstantiated, with questionable modality of truth claims.